

The River Answers Back: Consequences

河流的回应：后果

Theme: 环境、自然与可持续发展 · New: 44 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 44/6, 127

English Story

The consequences came as a difference between two medical opinions. A **republican** deputy and a **red cross** doctor stood on the **beach** and watched the **helicopter** bring a patient out of the valley. “The **illness** is not the flood,” the doctor said. “It is the water we drink after it.” A **rapid flash** of **lightning** lit the **jungle** behind them.

The health data of the district had a **bias** that nobody had written down: the people who filled in the forms were the ones who could **breathe** easily. “My hospital sees the same set,” she said. “The simple things, the low things, the things someone never reports.” A **steak** and a jar of oil on the table were the whole of a good week.

The **outdoor** workers had **cholesterol** and **thunder** in their ears and nothing else. “You can **transplant** a kidney but not a river,” the doctor said, and the **transplantation** of the old dam was, in her view, an **inferior** solution. A **ski** slope on a **volcanic** hillside, a **staircase** of concrete, and a **magnetic** scan of the soil: the project had produced better evidence than the ministry.

The **earthquake** of the previous year had buried a family under a **stair**, and nobody in the ministry had quaked. “**Sunshine** and a favourable wind are not a strategy,” the deputy said, and his words went **forth** into the record.

The **lively** part of the meeting was the quarrel about the **silicon** in the river: a **paw** of mud, a **plow** in the field, a **stocking** full of samples, and a **vapour** of doubt. “You can **bathe** in this water,” he said, “but you cannot **shave** in it and call it clean.”

The **energetic** minority won one point: a home-monitoring scheme with a **transplant** check, a set of readings within the same week, and a re-measurement after each flood. The environment, the doctor said, is not a game between two parties. A **favorable** wind, a **biblical** flood, and a **continent** of mud: nothing would **hinder** the plan more than a short **breath**. The price of a **transplant** was **advantageous**, and the eagle could **soar** above it all.

中文翻译

后果表现为两种医学意见之间的差异。一位共和派议员和一位红十字医生站在海滩上，看着直升机把一个病人从山谷里带出来。“病不在洪水里，”医生说，“而在洪水之后我们喝的水里。”一道迅速的闪电照亮了他们身后的丛林。

这个地区的健康数据有一个没人写下来的偏差：填表的人是那些呼吸顺畅的人。“我的医院看到的是同一套人，”她说，“简单的事、低处的事，以及某人从不汇报的事。”桌上的一块牛排和一罐油，就是好一周的全部。

户外工作者耳朵里有胆固醇和雷声，别的什么也没有。“你可以移植一颗肾，但不能移植一条河，”医生说，而旧坝的移植在她看来是个较差的方案。火山坡上的滑雪道、一段混凝土楼梯，以及一次对土壤的磁性扫描：这个项目产出的证据比部里更好。

前一年的地震把一家人埋在了一段楼梯下面，而部里没有人颤抖过。“阳光和顺风不是一种策略，”议员说，而他的话传了出去，进了记录。

会上生动活泼的部分是关于河里硅的争吵：一只带泥的爪子、田里的一张犁、一只装满样本的长袜，以及一团怀疑的蒸气。“你可以在这种水里沐浴，”他说，“但你不能在里面刮胡子，然后称它干净。”

精力充沛的少数人赢得了一点：一项家庭监测计划，配一次移植检查、一周内的同一套读数，以及每次洪水之后的重新测量。环境，医生说，不是两党之间的一场比赛。一阵顺风、一场圣经式的洪水，以及一片泥泞的大陆：没有什么比一口短缺的呼吸更能阻碍这个计划了。移植的代价是有利的，而那只鹰可以翱翔在这一切之上。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
republican ri'pʌblɪkən POS: n	n. 共和主义者, 共和党员; a. 共和政体的, 共和国的, 共和主义的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a member of the Republican Party; n. an advocate of a republic (usually in opposition to a monarchy); n. a t...
red red POS: a	a. 红的, 红色的, 红肿的, 流血的; n. 红色, 红颜料, 赤字; [计] 简化, 减少 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. red color or pigment; the chromatic color resembling the hue of blood; n. a tributary of the Mississippi Ri...
breath breθ POS: n	n. 呼吸, 气息, 瞬间; [医] 呼气, 呵气, 口气, 呼吸 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the process of taking in and expelling air during breathing; n. the air that is inhaled and exhaled in resp...
forth fɔ:θ POS: adv	adv. 往前, 以后, 向外 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a river in southern Scotland that flows eastward to the Firth of Forth; r. forward in time or order or degr...
beach bi:tʃ POS: n	n. 海滩 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an area of sand sloping down to the water of a sea or lake; v. land on a beach
breathe bri:ð POS: vi	vi. 呼吸, 生存, 低语; vt. 呼吸, 使喘息, 发散, 低声说 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. draw air into, and expel out of, the lungs; v. be alive; v. impart as if by breathing; v. allow the passage o...
illness 'ɪlnɪs POS: n	n. 疾病, 恶意; [医] 病 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. impairment of normal physiological function affecting part or all of an organism
bury 'beri POS: vt	vt. 埋葬, 埋藏 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. cover from sight; v. place in a grave or tomb; v. place in the earth and cover with soil; v. embed deeply
rapid 'ræpid POS: a	a. 迅速的, 飞快的, 急促的, 陡的; n. 急流 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a part of a river where the current is very fast; s. done or occurring in a brief period of time; s. charact...
stair steə POS: n	n. 梯级, 楼梯, 阶梯 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n support consisting of a place to rest the foot while ascending or descending a stairway
ski ski: POS: n	n. 滑雪橇; vi. 滑雪 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. narrow wood or metal or plastic runners used in pairs for gliding over snow; v. move along on skis
helicopter 'helɪkɒptə POS: n	n. 直升机; vt. 由直升机运送; vi. 乘直升机 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an aircraft without wings that obtains its lift from the rotation of overhead blades
cholesterol kə'lestərol POS: n	n. 胆固醇; [化] 胆固醇; 胆固醇 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an animal sterol that is normally synthesized by the liver; the most abundant steroid in animal tissues
flash flæʃ POS: n	n. 闪光, 闪现, 一瞬间; vi. 闪光, 闪现, 反射; vt. 使闪光, 反射 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a sudden intense burst of radiant energy; n. a momentary brightness; n. a short vivid experience; n. a sudden...
outdoor 'aʊtɒ: POS: a	a. 户外的, 屋外的, 露天的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. located, suited for, or taking place in the open air; a. pertaining to or concerning the outdoors or outdoo...
continent 'kɒntɪnənt POS: n	n. 大陆, 洲; a. 自制的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. one of the large landmasses of the earth; n. the European mainland; a. having control over urination and def...
bias 'baɪəs POS: n	n. 偏见, 斜纹; a. 偏斜的; adv. 偏斜; vt. 使有偏见; [计] 偏流; 偏压; 偏磁; 偏离 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a partiality that prevents objective consideration of an issue or situation; v. influence in an unfair way; ...
lively 'laɪvli POS: a	a. 活泼的, 鲜明的, 生动的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. full of life and energy; s. full of zest or vigor; s. filled with events or activity
earthquake 'e:θkweɪk POS: n	n. 地震 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. shaking and vibration at the surface of the earth resulting from underground movement along a fault plane...
magnetic mæɡ'netɪk POS: a	a. 有磁性的, 有吸引力的, 催眠术的; [医] 磁[性]的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or relating to or caused by magnetism; a. having the properties of a magnet; i.e. of attracting iron or...

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jungle 'dʒʌŋɡl POS: n	n. 丛林, 杂乱的一堆, 弱肉强食的地方 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a location marked by an intense competition and struggle for survival; n. an impenetrable equatorial forest
lightning 'laɪtnɪŋ POS: n	n. 闪电; vi. 闪电; a. 闪电的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. abrupt electric discharge from cloud to cloud or from cloud to earth accompanied by the emission of light; ...
steak steɪk POS: n	n. 牛排, 鱼排, 肉排 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a slice of meat cut from the fleshy part of an animal or large fish
soar sɔː POS: n	n. 高扬, 翱翔; vi. 往上飞舞, 高耸, 翱翔 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of rising upward into the air; v. rise rapidly; v. fly upwards or high in the sky; v. go or move upwa...
sunshine 'sʌnʃaɪn POS: n	n. 阳光, 光明, 晴天 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n the rays of the sun; n moderate weather; suitable for outdoor activities; n the quality of being cheerful and...
favorable 'feɪvərəbl POS: a	a. 有利的, 赞许的, 良好的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. encouraging or approving or pleasing; a. (of winds or weather) tending to promote or facilitate; s. occurri...
biblical 'bɪblɪkəl POS: a	a. 圣经的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or pertaining to or contained in or in accordance with the Bible; a. in keeping with the nature of the B...
transplant træns'plɑːnt POS: vt	vt. 使移居, 移植, 使迁移; vi. 移居, 耐移植; n. 移居者, 移植 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an operation moving an organ from one organism (the donor) to another (the recipient); n. the act of removi...
staircase 'steɪkeɪs POS: n	n. 楼梯, 梯子, 楼梯部分; [医] 阶梯现象 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a way of access (upward and downward) consisting of a set of steps
shave ʃeɪv POS: n	n. 修面, 刮胡子, 幸免, 剃刀; vt. 修面, 剃, 修剪, 掠过; vi. 刮脸, 勉强通过 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of removing hair with a razor; v. remove body hair with a razor; v. cut closely; v. cut the price of
inferior ɪn'fɪəriə POS: a	a. 次等的, 较差的, 下方的, 下级的; n. 部下, 次品, 下标(符号) Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. one of lesser rank or station or quality; a. of or characteristic of low rank or importance; a. of low or in...
stocking 'stɒkɪŋ POS: n	n. 长袜; [医] 马足水肿; 长袜 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. close-fitting hosiery to cover the foot and leg; come in matched pairs (usually used in the plural); n. the...
thunder 'θʌndə POS: n	n. 雷, 雷声; vi. 打雷, 轰隆地响, 怒喝; vt. 大声喊出, 轰隆地发出 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a booming or crashing noise caused by air expanding along the path of a bolt of lightning; v. move fast, no...
energetic .ənə'dʒetɪk POS: a	a. 精力充沛的, 积极的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. possessing or exerting or displaying energy; s. working hard to promote an enterprise
volcanic vɒl'kæɪnɪk POS: a	a. 火山的, 猛烈的; n. 火山岩 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. relating to or produced by or consisting of volcanoes; s. explosively unstable; s. igneous rock produced by...
hinder 'hɪndə POS: a	a. 后面的; v. 阻碍, 打扰 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v be a hindrance or obstacle to; v hinder or prevent the progress or accomplishment of; v put at a disadvantage...
bathe beɪð POS: vt	vt. 沐浴, 用水洗; vi. 洗澡 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of swimming; v. cleanse the entire body; v. suffuse with or as if with light; v. clean one's body by...
vapour 'veɪpə POS: n	n. 汽, 蒸气; vi. 蒸发, 吹牛; vt. 使蒸发, 使汽化 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a visible suspension in the air of particles of some substance; n the process of becoming a vapor
paw pɔː POS: n	n. 爪; v. 以蹄扒地, 用爪子抓, 拼命抓, 向...乱抓, 笨拙地使用, 费力地前进 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a clawed foot of an animal especially a quadruped; v. scrape with the paws; v. touch clumsily
plow plau POS: n	n. 犁; v. 犁, 耕 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a farm tool having one or more heavy blades to break the soil and cut a furrow prior to sowing; v. to break...
silicon 'sɪlɪkən POS: n	n. 硅; [化] 硅Si Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a tetravalent nonmetallic element; next to oxygen it is the most abundant element in the earth's crust; oc...

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quake kweɪk POS: vi	vi. 颤抖, 地震; n. 颤抖, 地震 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n shaking and vibration at the surface of the earth resulting from underground movement along a fault plane o...
advantageous ˌædvən'teɪdʒəs POS: a	a. 有利的, 有益的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. giving an advantage; s. appropriate for achieving a particular end; implies a lack of concern for fairness
transplantation trænsplɑ:n'teɪʃən POS: n	n. 移植, 移民, 移植术; [医] 移植术 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n an operation moving an organ from one organism (the donor) to another (the recipient); n the act of removing...